Writing Assignment, Part 2: Essay

ECON 201

Due Monday, December 7, before class, on Canvas. Worth 10% of your course grade.

In Part 1 you proposed a question about a pattern of events or behavior you observed, and I gave you feedback on it. **Now answer the question with an idea from this course, following that feedback.** If the feedback asked you to change the question or the idea, use the new one here.

Your Essay

Write an essay of **no more than 400 words**, entered directly as text on Canvas, that covers the following, **in this order**:

1. What did you observe, where, and when, and why is it puzzling?
2. What is your question? State it in one sentence.
3. What is the answer? Name the course idea, explain it in plain words, and apply it to what you observed step by step. A partial answer is fine if you say what it leaves unexplained.

The first two items are the same as in your proposal, so you can reuse what you wrote there. Write for a reader with no economics background, using plain language rather than graphs or equations, and explain each economics term the first time you use it.

Grading Rubric

Essay (10 points)	**Points**
The puzzle is clear: what you observed, where and when, and why it is surprising	2
The answer: a course idea is named, explained correctly, and applied step by step to what you observed, so that the puzzle is resolved	5
Clear writing: plain language that a reader with no economics background can follow, with each economics term explained the first time it is used	2
The essay follows my feedback on the proposal; if no change was asked for, keeping your question and idea earns this point	1